

enhancing the chances of successful transplantation. Dr. Attawar's trailblazing work continues to inspire and redefine the landscape of organ transplantation in India. Speaking to the India today, Dr Attawar says "As the director, it has been my intentional strategy to provide young and dynamic doctors with early exposure to the art of lung transplant. In a country where the field of lung transplant was nonexistent, we were able to create a pioneering program which is at par with one of best programs in the world. In India where organ donations are few and far apart, we overcame this challenge by creating a hub and spoke model wherein we have several satellite centers spread all across the vastness of this country with a network of dedicated interdisciplinary professionals who work seamlessly in a synchronized manner contributing to the program making it one of the fastest growing solid organ transplant networks in the world"

For any chronic lung disease, time is of the essence as their health can deteriorate rapidly. Thanks to the untiring efforts of Dr. Attawar and team, transplant patients now experience significantly reduced wait times. This is partly attributed to the fact that the state of Telangana has been a leader in organ donation, accounting for the highest number of donations in the country making Hyderabad the 'transplant capital' of India. Also Dr. Attawar's team works round the clock travelling to the remotest part of the country to screen organs with their stringent protocols. Once accepted, the organs are harvested and transported within a stipulated timeframe, sometimes via a chartered flight. Also their patient centric care and commendable pulmonary rehabilitation program ensures a shorter waitlist mortality. Once the transplant is done, the patient is shifted to a state-of-the-art ICU which has independent rooms with the most advanced Air handling unit (AHU) facility, ensuring close to zero infections post operatively. The program also uses an advanced software that captures every single parameter of the patient, which can be accessed by the healthcare provider with just a click of a button. Another unique feature of the app is that, the patient can connect to the doctor with a mere click. The institute offers comprehensive postoperative care with interventional pulmonology services. Speaking to India today, Dr Vijil Rahulan, the chief of transplant pulmonology says "Success of transplantation is not just in the surgery, but how to take the patient back to a situation where he could lead a productive and fulfilling life. At KIMS heart and lung transplant institute, we strive to use cutting edge technology and comprehensive monitoring protocols to complement surgical expertise and medical infrastructure to maximize patient outcomes and long term survival".



Dr. Attawar's team has been instrumental in introducing path-breaking techniques such as Ex-vivo lung perfusion (EVLP), extracorporeal photopheresis (ECP) & size reduced lung transplantation, which has broadened the scope of lung transplantation and significantly improved patient outcomes. The program's indigenous and innovative protocols have been instrumental in augmenting longevity of transplant patients and improving quality of life. Their hub & spoke model ensures that it's life saving treatments are accessible to patients from all across the country. Although the team primarily operates from its epicenter at Hyderabad, it also performs surgeries at satellite centers in Bangalore, Ahmedabad, Chennai, Mumbai and Pune, with more centers slated to open in the near future. Apart from this, they conduct outreach clinics in over 20 cities bringing transplant care at the doorstep. Dr. Attawar's team is further raising the bar by introducing live lobar lung transplants for the first time

in India, in which part of the lung from both parents are transplanted to children with severely diseased lung thereby helping them breaking the shackles of illness. Recently the team has acquired accreditation to perform heart transplant free of cost for patients under 'Arogyasri scheme' which is a flagship scheme of the Telangana government. The institute of heart and lung transplant at KIMS hospital is one of the few centers in India that offers highly sophisticated LVAD surgery for patients who have reached end-stage heart failure. Several success stories are the testament of tireless efforts of the entire team which operates seamlessly like a well oiled machine. Lives once confined by illness are now liberated with recipients breathing freely and embracing newfound opportunities. The transplant program at KIMS Hospital under the able leadership of Dr. Attawar is not merely a medical endeavour; it's a profound testament to the power of compassion, innovation and the indomitable human spirit.